Learn the Signs. Act Early.

Milestones by 6 Months

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For Everyone

MAY 15, 2026 • ESPAÑOL

WHAT TO KNOW

- Learn about the developmental milestones that most babies do by six months of age.
- See important information to share with your doctor.
- Find tips and activities you can do for your six-month-old.



Ways to monitor milestones

How your child plays, learns, speaks, acts, and moves offers important clues about your child's development. Developmental miles things most children (75% or more) can do by a certain age.

Milestone checklists

Check the milestones your baby has reached by 6 months by completing a checklist, available below and in three additional forma

- CDC's free *Milestone Tracker* mobile app, for iOS and Android devices
- Web-based Digital Online Checklist
- Printable checklist PDF

Keep in mind

"Learn the Signs. Act Early." materials are not a substitute for standardized, validated developmental screening tools.

What most babies do by 6 months

Click the links below to view a photo or video of each milestone.

Social/Emotional Milestones

- Knows familiar people
- Likes to look at self in a mirror
- Laughs

Language/Communication Milestones

- Takes turns making sounds with you
- Blows “raspberries” (sticks tongue out and blows)
- Makes squealing noises

Cognitive Milestones (learning, thinking, problem-solving)

- Puts things in her mouth to explore them
- Reaches to grab a toy she wants
- Closes lips to show she doesn’t want more food

Movement/Physical Development Milestones

- Rolls from tummy to back
- Pushes up with straight arms when on tummy
- Leans on hands to support herself when sitting

SEE ALSO
More about physical development

Share with your child’s doctor

Things to share and consider

- What are some things you and your baby do together?
- What are some things your baby likes to do?
- Is there anything your baby does or does not do that concerns you?
- Has your baby lost any skills he/she once had?
- Does your baby have any special healthcare needs or was he/she born prematurely?

If you or the doctor are still concerned

- Ask for a referral to a specialist who can evaluate your child more; and
- Call your state or territory's early intervention program to find out if your child can get services to help. Learn more and find t at cdc.gov/FindEI.

KEEP READING
Concerned About Your Child's Development?

Tips and activities

What You Can Do for Your 6-month-old



As your baby's first teacher, you can help his or her development.

As your baby's first teacher, you can help his or her learning and brain development. Try these simple tips and activities in a safe w your baby's doctor and teachers if you have questions or for more ideas on how to help your baby's development.

- Use "back and forth" play with your baby. When your baby smiles, you smile; when he makes sounds, you copy them. This helps be social.
- "Read" to your baby every day by looking at colorful pictures in magazines or books and talk about them. Respond to her when s and "reads" too. For example, if she makes sounds, say "Yes, that's the doggy!"
- Point out new things to your baby and name them. For example, when on a walk, point out cars, trees, and animals.

More Parenting Tips and Activities

- Sing to your baby and play music. This will help his brain develop.
- Limit screen time (TV, tablets, phones, etc.) to video calling with loved ones. Screen time is not recommended for children yo 2 years of age. Babies learn by talking, playing, and interacting with others.
- When your baby looks at something, point to it and talk about it.
- Put your baby on her tummy or back and put toys just out of reach. Encourage her to roll over to reach the toys.
- Learn to read your baby's moods. If he's happy, keep doing what you are doing. If he's upset, take a break and comfort your b
- Talk with your baby's doctor about when to start solid foods and what foods are choking risks. Breast milk or formula is still important source of "food" for your baby.
- Learn when your baby is hungry or full. Pointing to foods, opening his mouth to a spoon, or getting excited when seeing food that he is hungry. Others, like pushing food away, closing his mouth, or turning his head away from food tells you that he's h
- Help your baby learn she can calm down. Talk softly, hold, rock, or sing to her, or let her suck on her fingers or a pacifier. You favorite toy or stuffed animal while you hold or rock her.
- Hold your baby up while she sits. Let her look around and give her toys to look at while she learns to balance herself.
- Hold your baby with both of your hands securely under her arms and let her stand. Look around with your baby and name w see while she is standing.
- Introduce your baby to different sounds and voices. For example, whisper, clap, or make funny noises. See if your baby looks curious and see which sounds she prefers.
- Playing on the floor or play mat with your baby every day helps him to move, learn, and explore.
- When he drops a toy on the floor, pick it up and give it back. This game helps him learn cause and effect.

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SOURCES AND PAGE INFO

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National Center on Birth Defects and Developmental Disabilities (NCBDDD)

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SOURCES

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